ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

# COMMISSION MEETING FORM

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| **MEETING NO.** | 159th Commission Meeting |
| **DATE:** | 10 January 2024 |
| **TIME:** | 02:00 PM |
| **VENUE:** | *Druk Dradhir Khang* |

| # | AGENDA & DISCUSSION | DECISION |
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| 1 | Draft research proposal on forestry services and election – DoPE<br><br>*EAD presented on the draft proposal to conduct observational and perception study on forestry services and election respectively. The observational study on forestry services aims to evaluate the effectiveness of existing anti-corruption measures in preventing corruption vulnerabilities and accordingly recommend mitigation measures. It proposes to study the nine existing online services provided by the Department of Forest & Park Services (DoFPS) through its 14 sub-divisions spread across the country. To complement the NIA methodology, the study proposes adopting qualitative approach, including focus group discussion, semi-structured interview & observational checklist. Meanwhile, the perception study on election aims to assess voter perception on corrupt practices in electoral processes through structured questionnaire with voters, national observers, and returning/election officers. Powerpoint slides attached.*<br><br>*To this, the Commission raised concerns about whether the observational study on forestry services would affect the ongoing systems study on timber extraction conducted by PD from the perspective of the agency's cooperation for the study and duplication of efforts. Furthermore, the Commission questioned whether the services listed in the proposal are comprehensive enough to understand corruption vulnerability and align with the services identified as vulnerable in the NIA 2022. Regarding the perception study on elections, the Commission discussed the need to ensure that the timing and intent of the study* | **Commission directed to present the two proposals with following specific directives to:**<br><br>- **ensure comprehensive listing of all the services provided by DoFPS and conduct thorough desk review of the service manuals, including an analysis of the available data such as complaints, cases, resource allocation, import & export, among others, before commencing the study. This is expected to not only narrow down to the most vulnerable service but also facilitate in ensuring targeted focused group discussions and semi-structured interviews.**<br><br>- **explore, wherever possible, areas of consolidation with the ongoing systems study on timber allocation to minimize duplication of efforts and garner cooperation from the agency concerned.**<br><br>- **revise the proposal to conduct perception study on election indicating study of corruption in elections overall, rather than specifying the recent elections alone. Also reflect aspects that could be taken up with ECB esp. where existing ECB info such as disputes during the election** |

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| | *does not send wrong message on the recent election results.*<br><br>*Following this, the EAD presented an overview of the Bhutan National Digital Identify (NDI) initiative and its technology concerning potential corruption vulnerabilties. The paper on the same was proposed for jounral publication and sensitization to all the ACC staff. Powerpoint slides attached.* | **period.**<br><br>- **A work-plan for the way forward, incl. for elections and forestry services, to be apprised to the Commission.**<br><br>**Acknowledging the corruption risks associated with the NDI initiative in general, besides its prospective benefits, the Commission directed to share the paper with the relevant stakeholders for timely intervention. Additionally, the Commission advised the Departments/Divisions within the ACC to start internalizing in the initiative into their respective processes/systems. In this regard, the Commission directed to explore integrating NDI with the ADS and sensitize the ACC staff during the upcoming QSM.** |
| 2 | Draft policy & procedure on proactive investigation – PPD | **Deferred** |
| 3 | Draft agenda for 13th QSM – PPD<br><br>*PPD presented the draft agenda on the theme 'Our དཀའ་བཅད: Reinforcing Mission 114' tentatively scheduled on 19 January 2024 from Phuntsholing Regional Office. Draft agenda attached.* | **Commission approved the draft agenda with following directives to:**<br><br>- **postpone to 22 January 2024.**<br><br>- **prepare the list of those who have volunteered during the last three months along with their duration of input.**<br><br>- **move activity on 'offering *དཀའ་བཅད' at the Head Office towards morning with same proceedings as done during the 18th Foundation Day.*** |
| 4 | Any others:<br><br>- Update on hosting of ADB/OECD Anti-Corruption Initiative Seminar – PPD<br><br>*Apprised the Commission on the preliminary meeting held with the OECD on the hosting of ADB/OECD Anti-Corruption Initiative Seminar towards latter part of 2024 wherein the OECD agreed to ensure availability of funding for the event, provided that the ACC is willing to coordinate local logistics. Furthermore, the OECD also* | **Noted and directed to prepare internally on engagement of critical partners, such as CSOs, media and member of UNCAC Expert Group, as well as marketing of the ACC's initiatives (IVS, NIA, PII, YIP – Damtsi, ACA Strengthening – highlighting stronger points). Simultaneously, directed the PPD to begin preparing submission notes on the event to the relevant authorities.** |

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| | *informed on the possibility of aligning the focus of the seminar in line with the ACC's priority. For more clarity, the OECD would be sharing a detailed concept paper, expected participants, tentative dates including the division of responsibilities between the host country and OECD.*<br><br>- Regular HR updates – HRS<br><br>*Apprised the Commission on the list of STT & LTT areas prioritized for onward submission to the RCSC. Additionally, the HRS provided an update on the RCSC's advice to consider initial application of intent to study by Menuka Rai. The Commission was informed about accepting her resignation with one month's notice, without having to adhere to the revised provisions in the BCSR 2023.* | **Noted.** |

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| *-Bereavement Leave-* | | |
| **Commissioner** | **Commissioner** | **Chairperson** |

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